

DEĞER - VALUE

“ What we value is a reflection of our own values ”
UNIVERSAL LUXURY AND BEYOND...



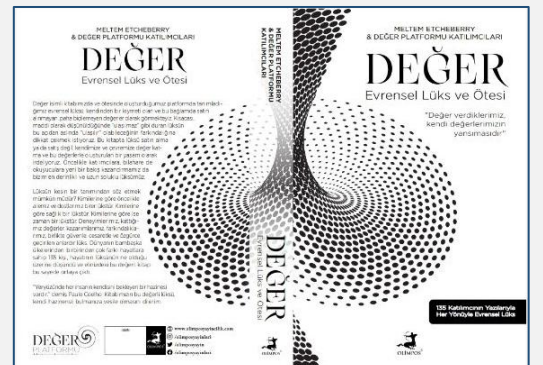
OUR VALUES

- Rarity, Ephemerality and Elegance
- Ethics, Reliability and Integrity
- Impeccability, Appreciation and Merit
- Harmony, Balance and Consistency
- Authenticity, Sincerity and Spontaneity
- Benevolence, Open-mindedness and Kindness
- Understanding our Human Richness and Individual Design as luxury

“ Don’t go where the road takes you.
Go where there is no road, so that you can leave a Trace”
Ralph Waldo Emerson

Our chapters :

- Preface / Thoughts after earthquake 2023
- Luxury / A brief History
- Universal Luxury and Ethic
- Universal Luxury and Perfectionnisme
- Universal Luxury and Harmony - Balance
- Universal Luxury and Art of Welcoming
- Universal Luxury and Travel
- Universal Luxury and Cultural Diversity - Inclusion
- Universal Luxury and Ecology - Circular Économy
- Universal Luxury and Time
- Universal Luxury and Fine Arts - 5 Senses
- Universal Luxury and Design Thinking
- Universal Luxury and Innovation
- Universal Luxury and Technology
- Universal Luxury and Play - Gaming
- Universal Luxury and Healty
- Universal Luxury and Communication
- Universal Luxury and Human Richness
- Universal Luxury and Courtesy
- Universal Luxury and Trust
- Universal Luxury and Leadership



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UNIVERSAL LUXURY AND BEYOND...

Our INTRODUCTION... : WHAT IS OUR UNIVERSAL LUXURY ?

Universal luxury is the sharing of inclusive principles and values that touch the present and future generations and all living things with the traces of the past. In a naïve way, universal luxury is a subject that almost everyone knows something about, and yet, a subject few understand. Etymologically, the first thing that comes to mind in the context of *luxus-lumen* is that it is like a measurable unit. In fact, here, we wish to detail luxury as a set of spiritual and universally-held common values. Universal luxury is self-worth, it is freedom, it is peace, it is love, it is respect. This luxury is true and real. What we value is the reflection of our own values.

Indeed, our experiences, our value contributions, our achievements, our awareness, the moments we spent together, with confidence, courage and freedom are our luxuries. Luxury is Kairos. It is Kintsugi, Ikigai, Yin-Yang, Ganbaru, Sisu... it's Ubuntu. Universal Luxury is not «*having, possessing, buying or receiving*», but «*being*». It is not about to be rich (quantity), but about the wealth of existing (quality). From that point of view, it is Zen. I would like to add that in our book, we mainly focused on eudaimonic perspective of luxury, (meaning, purpose, sustainability), and not the hedonic (pleasure, relativity, temporariness).

In our new book that begins with this article, we view the universal luxury we define within the context of our created platform as innate values that cannot be bought or taken in this context. In short, we wanted to convey the awareness that luxury, which seems to be «*inaccessible*» when considered materially, can be «*accessible*» in this respect. We examine luxury not as a commodity that one can buy or sell, but as adding values to ourselves and our environment and life within the context of these values. Primarily, it is our deepest and long-term luxury to give a new perspective to the participants, and also to the readers.

Undoubtedly, the products of «*Maison*», or other internationally-referenced brands, hand-carved precious jewels, uniquely creative services or elite gourmet and hospitality sectors would be viewed as luxury by many. Of course, we can add more to these definitions. I have just given some examples that are the most important ones to me, those that are consistent with the perspective of the book.

On the other hand, what I heard, saw and read between January and October 2022 made me want to enrich the «universal luxury» of the book in the process. First of all, I asked for ideas and articles from my circle of colleagues and friends who could look at luxury from this perspective. But the rarity of this book has come from the inclusion of many young Turkish people living in big or small cities in Turkey, and all over the world.

So we started a journey together (Luxury & Design Thinking part). Indeed, our book is not about «how much I know », but about «how many different points of view we bring together». It is necessary to evaluate all articles through this lens. We wanted this book to be a free pulpit.

It is very meaningful to see that my understanding of universal luxury, which I have especially underlined «before and after Covid», has developed and enhanced with the different perspectives and new ideas of 135 contributors of all ages and professions from all over the world and Turkey, all of them are unique stories, incredible precious gems.

Life is full of beautiful surprises. «*Everyone on earth has a treasure that awaits them*» says Paolo Coelho - The Alchemist. Our book, which I sincerely hope will be instrumental in finding this precious universal luxury and treasure of all of us, has now led us to create an amazing and innovative international youth platform :

DEĞER Platformu (VALUE International Young Entrepreneurship and Value Union Platform).